



FIRE WORM

Hermodice carunculata
F: Amphinomidæ

A tropical Atlantic offshore species, this polychaete preys on corals, sucking out the soft flesh from the hard skeleton. Its body extensions have painfully irritating bristles.

6–30 cm
2¼–12 in

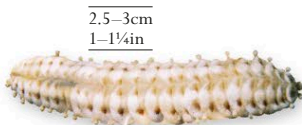


SEA MOUSE

Aphrodita aculeata
F: Aphroditidae

This mud-burrowing scale worm is found in the shallow waters of N. Europe. Its scales are covered with a hair-like coat.

10–20 cm
4–8 in



SEA CUCUMBER SCALE WORM

Gastrolepidia clavigera
F: Polynoidea

This Indo-Pacific polychaete has flattened back scales. It is parasitic on sea cucumbers.

2.5–3 cm
1–1¼ in



GREEN PADDLE WORM

Eulalia viridis
F: Phyllodocidae

Paddleworms are active carnivores with leaf-shaped flaps on their body extensions. This European species lives among intertidal rocks and kelp.

5–15 cm
2–6 in

PACIFIC FEATHERDUSTER WORM

Sabellastarte sanctijosephi
F: Sabellidae

A tropical Indo-Pacific tubeworm, this species is common along coastlines, including coral reefs and tidal pools.

8–10 cm
3¼–4 in



HONEYCOMB WORM

Sabellaria alveolata
F: Sabellaridae

This tubeworm builds its tubes from sand and shell fragments. Dense populations form honeycomb-like reefs in the Atlantic and Mediterranean.



25–40 cm
10–16 in

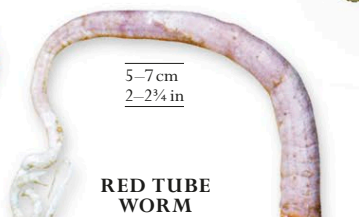


KING RAGWORM

Alitta virens
F: Nereididae

Ragworms, close relatives of paddleworms, have two-pronged body extensions. This Atlantic mud-burrowing species can deliver a painful bite.

5–7 cm
2–2¾ in



RED TUBE WORM

Serpula vermicularis
F: Serpulidae

Serpulid tubeworms build hard chalky tubes. Like most serpulids, this widespread species has tentacles modified to plug the tube after retraction.

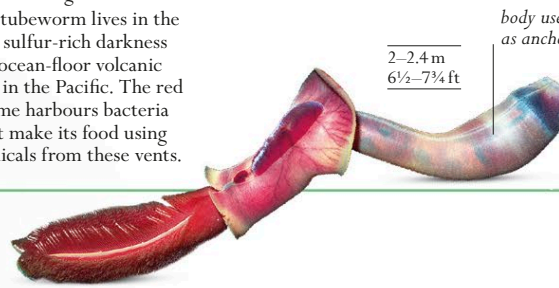
2–3 mm
¼–⅛ in

GIANT TUBE WORM

Riftia pachyptila
F: Siboglinidae

This tubeworm lives in the hot sulfur-rich darkness of ocean-floor volcanic vents in the Pacific. The red plume harbours bacteria that make its food using chemicals from these vents.

2–2.4 m
6½–7¾ ft



body used as anchor



NORTHERN SPIRAL TUBE WORM

Spirorbis borealis
F: Serpulidae

The small coiled tube of this tubeworm is cemented to brown *Fucus* seaweeds and kelps along North Atlantic coastlines.

WATER BEARS

Visible only through a microscope, stubby-legged, agile water bears share their aquatic community with microbes and far simpler invertebrates.

Tiny water bears, or tardigrades (meaning “slow-stepped”) clamber through miniature forests of water weed, four pairs of short legs clinging on with clawed feet. Most are less than a millimetre long. They abound among moss or

algae, where many use their needle-like jaws to pierce the cells of this vegetation and suck its sap. Many water bear species are known only as females, which reproduce asexually by spawning offspring from unfertilized eggs. If its habitat dries up, a water bear is able to survive by going into a kind of suspended animation called cryptobiosis, shrivelling into a husk, sometimes for years at a time, until rainfall revives it.

PHYLUM	TARDIGRADA
CLASSES	3
ORDERS	5
FAMILIES	20
SPECIES	About 1,000

MOSS WATER BEAR

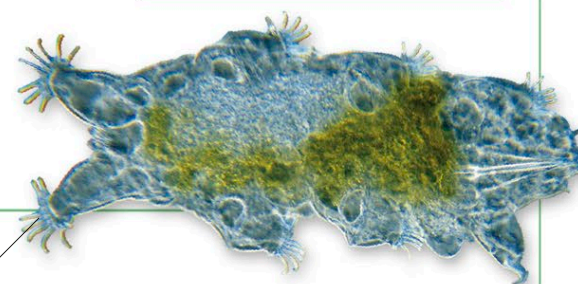
Echiniscus sp.
F: Echiniscidae

Many water bears live in moss, but their ability to survive in a dried state has helped a number of species to disperse worldwide.

0.25mm



clawed feet



SEAWEED WATER BEAR

Echiniscoides sigismundi
F: Echiniscoididae

One of many little-known marine water bears, this species has been recorded among seaweed in coastal locations around the world.

0.25mm